

Ros Clayton

PhD Candidate in Economics, Stellenbosch University
rclayton@sun.ac.za

Research Fields

Economics of Education; Development Economics; Applied Microeconometrics

Education

PhD in Economics, Stellenbosch University Expected 2027

Thesis: Foundational language skills, grade repetition, and educational attainment: Causal evidence from regression discontinuity designs

Supervisors: Dr Gabrielle Wills and Prof. Servaas van der Berg

MPhil Education, University of Cambridge 2015

BSocSci (Hons) Economics, University of Cape Town 2011

BSocSci Economics and Mathematics, University of Cape Town 2007–2010

Working Papers

The impact of early grade repetition on test scores: Evidence from a regression discontinuity design in South Africa
Resep working paper, 2025.

Extended version of the paper submitted to this workshop. Uses administrative data for six provinces and an RD design to estimate the causal impact of Grade 1 and Grade 4 repetition on later achievement.

Linguistic interdependence? Foundation Phase mastery in home language as a predictor of grade 4 repetition and EFAL marks

Resep working paper, 2025.

Studies the relationship between Foundation Phase language proficiency and later academic outcomes.

From Grade 7 arithmetic to matric: A quantitative evaluation of the Numeric afterschool maths program

Evaluation report, 2024.

Randomised evaluation of an after-school programme for primary school learners in South Africa, estimating causal impacts on academic outcomes up to high school completion.

Growing apart: Tracking the pro-girl achievement gap across early grades in South African primary schools
(Co-authored with Dr Gabrielle Wills)

Manuscript under revision for journal submission, 2026.

Responsible for data analysis and contributed to empirical strategy.

Research Experience

Researcher, Resep, Stellenbosch University 2024–present

- Designed and implemented causal inference studies using RD
- Analysed and cleaned large administrative datasets in R (data.table) and Stata
- Conducted quantile regression and fixed effects models to study educational outcomes

Researcher, Independent consultant 2023–2024

- Designed and implemented evaluation studies, including an RCT follow-up using administrative datasets
- Leveraged LLMs to code qualitative data

Presentations

The impact of early grade repetition on test scores: Evidence from a regression discontinuity design in South Africa
Economic Society of South Africa Centenary Conference (2025)

The effect of early-grade repetition on Home Language performance

Reading Panel, Johannesburg, 2026.

Linguistic interdependence? Foundation Phase mastery in home language as a predictor of grade 4 repetition and EFAL marks

RESEP Quantitative Education Conference, University of Stellenbosch (2025)

Policy writing

The impact of early grade repetition on learner marks

Resep policy brief, 2025.

How home language mastery predicts early learning outcomes

Resep policy brief, 2025.

Teaching Experience

University of Cape Town

Teaching Assistant, Analysis of Household Survey Data (Honours) 2012

Head Tutor, Game Theory 2011

Tutor 2010–2011

- Microeconomics I
- Game Theory
- Microeconomics III

Technical Skills

R, Stata, Python, LaTeX